



Simple Past & Past Continuous

Teacher
Renan Grossi
(51) 98135 3067

Quick Reminder

- **Past Continuous** (was/were + verb-ing) = longer background action
- **Past Simple** = shorter completed action that often interrupts the longer one

Exercise 1: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences with the correct form (Past Simple or Past Continuous).

1. While I _____ (walk) to the park, I _____ (see) an old friend.
2. She _____ (cook) dinner when the phone _____ (ring).
3. They _____ (play) football when it suddenly _____ (start) to rain.
4. I _____ (watch) TV when my brother _____ (come) home.
5. He _____ (read) a book while she _____ (write) a letter.
6. We _____ (have) dinner when the power _____ (go) out.
7. The students _____ (study) quietly when the fire alarm _____ (go) off.
8. I _____ (not / hear) the doorbell because I _____ (listen) to loud music.
9. She _____ (fall) asleep while she _____ (read) a book.
10. The cat _____ (chase) a mouse when it _____ (run) into a hole.

Exercise 2: Multiple Choice

Choose the correct form.

1. I _____ when the phone rang.
(a) slept (b) was sleeping
2. She _____ when I called her.
(a) cooked (b) was cooking
3. They _____ football when it started to rain.
(a) played (b) were playing

4. He _____ his homework when his friend arrived.
(a) did (b) was doing

5. While we _____ dinner, the lights went out.
(a) ate (b) were eating

6. I _____ TV when my mom came home.
(a) watched (b) was watching

7. She _____ the bus when she saw an accident.
(a) took (b) was taking

8. They _____ a movie when the power went out.
(a) watched (b) were watching

9. He _____ in the garden when it started to rain.
(a) worked (b) was working

10. I _____ breakfast when the doorbell rang.
(a) ate (b) was eating

5. (we / dinner / were eating / when / the guests / arrived) →

6. (the sun / shining / was / when / we / left / the house) →

7. (she / reading / a book / was / when / her brother / interrupted / her) →

8. (I / walking / to the store / was / when / I / met / an old friend) →

9. (the children / playing / outside / were / when / it / began / to snow) →

10. (we / having / a picnic / were / when / it / suddenly / started / to rain) →

Exercise 3: Sentence Formation

Rearrange the words to form correct sentences.

1. (I / TV / was watching / when / the phone / rang) →

2. (she / studying / was / for her exams / when / I / called / her) →

3. (they / soccer / playing / were / when / it / started / to rain) →

4. (he / finished / his homework / before / he / went out) →

1. He was played soccer when it started to rain. →

2. They was studying when the power went out. →

3. I finished my homework while I was watched TV. →

4. She was read a book when the phone rang. →

5. We were going to the beach and it starting raining. →

Exercise 4: Error Correction

Correct the mistakes.

6. He ate dinner when she was arrived. → Yesterday was a strange day. While I _____ (walk) to the store, I _____ (meet) an old friend. We _____ (talk) for a while, and then I _____ (continue) on my way. As I _____ (shop), I _____ (realize) I forgot my wallet. I _____ (feel) so embarrassed. While I _____ (return) home to get it, it _____ (start) to rain heavily. By the time I _____ (get) home, I was completely wet. Later, while I _____ (dry) myself off, my phone _____ (ring). It was my friend again. He _____ (want) to invite me to dinner, but I _____ (have) to decline because I was tired. It _____ (be) a very eventful day!
7. They were talked when the teacher walked in. → _____
8. I was taking a shower when the doorbell was rang. → _____
9. She was cooking dinner and then she burns her hand. → _____
10. We was having a picnic when the storm began. → _____

Exercise 5: Context-Based Text

Complete the text with the correct tense.